



Neighbours **CHINA**

The New LONG MARCH

China takes steps to bridge the worrying urban-rural gulf even as it battles the slowdown and ethnic unrest as Managing Editor **Raj Chengappa** finds out on a trip to Beijing and Shaanxi province



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Like the China of yore, the residents of Fang Jia Zhai village in Shaanxi province, located in the heart of the mainland, express themselves through intricate paintings on the walls of their compound. Many of them appear to depict the aphorisms that President Hu Jintao exhorts his countrymen to follow. Called "Eight Glories and the Eight Shames", they include phrases like "be disciplined and law-abiding, not chaotic and lawless" and "be honest, not profit-mongering". So



A TRADITIONAL FARMER IN ZHEJIANG; (INSET) HOUSES UNDER THE NEW COUNTRYSIDE PROGRAMME IN SHAANXI